

Notion Webhook

How changes made in Notion reach the KM Finny app automatically — what it does, how to set it up step by step, and how to check it is working.

For: admins and whoever sets up the server **Version:** 1.0 **Date:** 17 September 2026

- | | |
|---------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. What this does | 6. Check that it works |
| 2. How it works | 7. Troubleshooting |
| 3. Before you start | 8. Going live checklist |
| 4. Setup, step by step | 9. Good to know |
| 5. Server settings (.env) | 10. For developers |

1. What this does

Before: when someone changed something in Notion, the app did not know. Someone had to press *Sync*, or wait for the daily sync.

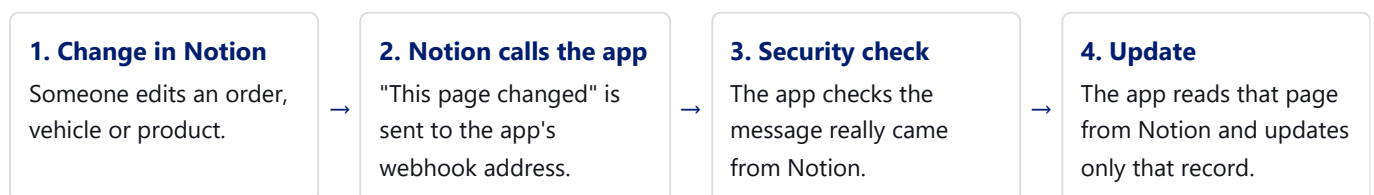
Now: when something changes in Notion, **Notion sends a message to the app right away**. The app updates only that one record. Nobody needs to press Sync for these changes.

Notion database	What the app updates
Orders	Only the Finny Status of the matching proforma slip (matched by order number). No other slip field is changed.
Vehicle Master	That vehicle's details. A vehicle that is new in Notion is added to the app.
Product Master	That product's details, including its photo. A product that is new in Notion is added to the app.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

It works like a doorbell. Instead of checking Notion every few minutes, Notion "rings" the app the moment something changes.

2. How it works



The details

- **Only which page changed is sent.** Notion's message does not include the new values, so the app reads that one page back from Notion and then updates its own record.

- **Security:** every message from Notion carries a signature made with a secret token. The app recalculates it and **rejects anything that does not match**, so nobody else can send fake changes.
- **Quick edits are grouped:** several edits to the same page within 3 seconds are handled as one update.
- **No loops:** when the app itself sends a status to Notion, Notion reports that change back. The app sees the value already matches and does nothing.
- **Speed:** changes usually arrive within a minute. Notion allows up to 5 minutes.
- **If the server is down:** Notion retries each message up to 8 times over about 24 hours, so a short outage does not lose changes.

3. Before you start

- ☐ **The app is reachable on the internet over https.** Notion cannot reach `localhost` . For testing on a PC, use a tunnel (step A).
- ☐ **Admin access in Notion** to the connection (integration) the app already uses.
- ☐ **Access to the server's `.env` file** and permission to restart the server.
- ☐ **An admin login to the KM Finny app**, to open the status page.

4. Setup, step by step

A Get a public https address for the app

Live server: use the real domain, for example `https://yourdomain.com` .

Testing on a PC (the app runs on port `5000`), use one of:

- **VS Code:** open the *Ports* panel → *Forward a Port* → enter `5000` . Then right-click the port → *Port Visibility* → **Public**. Copy the https address shown.
- **ngrok:** run `ngrok http 5000` and copy the https address.

IMPORTANT

A VS Code port is **Private** by default — Notion cannot reach it until it is set to Public. A tunnel address also changes each time it restarts, so it is only for testing.

B Give the connection access to the three databases

Open each database in Notion: **Orders**, **Vehicle Master** and **Product Master**. Click **...** (top right) → **Connections** and make sure the app's connection is listed. Notion only sends changes for pages the connection can see.

C Create the webhook subscription

1. Go to `https://app.notion.com/developers/connections` and open the app's connection.
2. Open the **Webhooks** tab → + **Create a subscription**.
3. **URL:** the address from step A followed by `/api/webhooks/notion`

```
https://yourdomain.com/api/webhooks/notion
```

4. **Events:** select `page.created` , `page.properties_updated` , `page.content_updated` , `page undeleted` , `page.moved` and `page.deleted` . Then create it.

D Verify the subscription

1. Right after creating it, Notion sends a one-time **verification token** to the app. It is printed in the **server log**, in a block starting with `Verification token received`. Copy the value that starts with `secret_`.
2. Back in Notion's Webhooks tab, click ⚠️ **Verify** (bottom left), paste the token, and click **Verify subscription**.

KEEP IT SECRET

This token proves messages really come from Notion. Do not share it in chat, email or screenshots.

E Save the token on the server

Add this line to the server's `.env` file, then **restart the server**:

```
NOTION_WEBHOOK_VERIFICATION_TOKEN=secret_XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
```

Until this is set, the app receives Notion's messages but ignores them.

F Test it

1. In Notion, change **Finny Status** on a test order.
2. Wait up to a minute (at most 5).
3. Open **Proforma Slips** in the app — the status should show the new value.
4. Change a field on a vehicle and on a product the same way, and check Vehicle Master and Product Master.

You can also check the status page (section 6).

G Move from testing to live

If you tested with a tunnel: in Notion, **edit the subscription URL** to the live domain, then **repeat steps D and E** — the new URL gets its own token.

5. Server settings (.env)

These are the settings the webhook uses. The last two are new; the others already exist for the Notion syncs. Never put real secret values in shared documents.

Setting	What it is for
<code>NOTION_INTEGRATION_SECRET</code>	Lets the app read pages from Notion (already in use).
<code>ORDER_DATABASE_ID</code>	Tells the app which Notion database is Orders (already in use).
<code>NOTION_VEHICLE_DATABASE_ID</code>	Which database is Vehicle Master (already in use).
<code>NOTION_INVENTORY_DATABASE_ID</code>	Which database is Product Master (already in use).
<code>NOTION_WEBHOOK_VERIFICATION_TOKEN</code> (new)	The secret token from step D. Required — without it all messages are ignored.
<code>NOTION_WEBHOOK_STATUS_URL</code> (new, optional)	Link opened by the Open status button in Settings. Example: <code>https://yourdomain.com/api/webhooks/notion/status</code>

After changing `.env`, restart the server so it picks up the change.

6. Check that it works

In the app, go to **Settings** → **Notion Webhook Status** → **Open status** (admins only). It opens a page listing the setup and the last 100 changes Notion sent.

Line	Meaning	You want to see
<code>tokenConfigured</code>	Is the secret token saved on the server?	<code>true</code>
<code>databasesConfigured</code>	Does the server know the three database IDs?	all three <code>true</code>
<code>lastVerificationAt</code>	When Notion last sent its verification (step D)	a date after setup
<code>pendingPages</code>	Changes waiting a few seconds before being applied	usually <code>0</code>
<code>recentActivity</code>	The last 100 changes, newest first, and what happened to each	see below

What each result means

Result	Meaning
updated	The change was saved in the app. For orders it shows the order number and new status, e.g. <code>updated (#100459 → DISPATCHED)</code> .
created	A new vehicle or product was added.
unchanged	The app already had that value — nothing to do.

Result	Meaning
ignored	Nothing to do: a page from another database, a page moved to trash, or the token is not set.
waiting	A full manual sync was running; the change will be retried in 30 seconds.
rejected	The signature did not match — the message did not come from Notion, or the token is wrong.
error	Something went wrong; the reason is shown next to it.

7. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause	What to do
Notion cannot verify / never sends the token	Address not public, not https, or wrong path	Check the URL ends with <code>/api/webhooks/notion</code> . For VS Code tunnels, set the port to Public .
Nothing changes in the app	Token not set on the server	Status page shows <code>tokenConfigured: false</code> → do step E and restart.
Results show rejected	Token on the server does not match this subscription	Copy the token again from the latest verification and update <code>.env</code> .
Results show ignored — not in the order, vehicle or product database	Database ID in <code>.env</code> is wrong, or the page is from another database	Check the three database IDs in <code>.env</code> .
No results at all for a database	Connection has no access to that database	Do step B for that database.
Results show error — could not read page	The app's Notion secret has no access or is wrong	Check <code>NOTION_INTEGRATION_SECRET</code> and step B.
Worked in testing, stopped after going live	Subscription still points to the old tunnel address	Do step G: change the URL, then repeat D and E.
The Open status button is greyed out	You are not logged in as an admin	Log in with an admin account.

8. Going live checklist

- ☐ Subscription URL is the live https domain + `/api/webhooks/notion`
- ☐ Subscription is verified in Notion
- ☐ `NOTION_WEBHOOK_VERIFICATION_TOKEN` is set on the live server, and the server was restarted
- ☐ The connection has access to Orders, Vehicle Master and Product Master
- ☐ A test status change appears in the app, and the status page shows **updated**
- ☐ `NOTION_WEBHOOK_STATUS_URL` points to the live domain (optional)

9. Good to know

- **For orders, only Finny Status is updated.** Other slip fields still come from Import / Sync from Notion.
- **Deleting in Notion does not delete in the app.** A page moved to trash is only noted on the status page.
- **The Sync buttons and the daily sync still exist** as a backup in case a change is ever missed. They can be turned off later, once the webhook has been confirmed working live.
- **The status page keeps the last 100 changes in memory** — it starts empty again after a server restart.

- **Vehicles and products use exactly the same rules as the Sync buttons**, so a webhook update and a manual sync always give the same result.

10. For developers

File	What it does
<code>server/routes/notion-webhook.ts</code>	The webhook: verification, signature check, grouping of quick edits, routing by database, the Finny Status update, and the admin status endpoints.
<code>server/services/notionVehicleSync.ts</code>	<code>applyVehiclePageFromNotionWebhook</code> — applies one Vehicle Master page using the existing sync mapping.
<code>server/services/notionInventorySync.ts</code>	<code>applyProductPageFromNotionWebhook</code> — applies one Product Master page, including its photo.
<code>server/index.ts</code>	Keeps the raw request body for <code>/api/webhooks/notion</code> only (needed for the signature check).
<code>server/routes.ts</code>	Registers the webhook routes.
<code>client/src/pages/Settings.tsx</code>	The Notion Webhook Status card and Open status button.

Endpoints

Endpoint	Who	Purpose
POST <code>/api/webhooks/notion</code>	Notion (public, signature required)	Receives verification and change events
GET <code>/api/webhooks/notion/status</code>	Admins	Setup state and recent activity
GET <code>/api/webhooks/notion/status-link</code>	Admins	Link used by the Settings button

Signature

X-Notion-Signature: sha256=<HMAC-SHA256 of the raw request body, key = verification token>